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ENG508 FINAL-TERM (By Capta!n ① Team)Vu

Helping Desk

1. Cooperative Principle

The **Cooperative Principle** means that people try to **help each other** in a conversation. They speak in a way that is **clear, useful, and easy to understand**.

Observing the Maxims

These are the rules for a good conversation.

- **Maxim of Quantity:** Give the **right amount** of information (not too much, not too little).
- **Maxim of Quality:** Say **only what is true**.
- **Maxim of Relation:** Say **relevant** things.
- **Maxim of Manner:** Speak **clearly and in order**.

Flouting the Maxims

A person **intentionally breaks** a maxim to give an **indirect meaning**, make a joke, or use sarcasm.

Violating the Maxims

A person **breaks a maxim without intention**, which may cause **confusion or misunderstanding**.

Limitations of the Cooperative Principle

The Cooperative Principle does not always work because people may use **sarcasm, indirect speech, jokes, or unclear language** instead of following the maxims.

2. Relevance Theory

What is Relevance Theory?

Relevance Theory says that people understand messages by choosing the **most useful and relevant information**.

Principles of Relevance Theory

- **Cognitive Principle:** People pay attention to **useful information**.
- **Communicative Principle:** People expect the speaker to give **relevant information**.

Explicature and Implicature

- **Explicature:** The **direct and clear meaning** of a sentence.
- **Implicature:** The **hidden or implied meaning** understood from the context.

Conceptual and Procedural Meaning

- **Conceptual Meaning:** The **literal meaning** of words.
- **Procedural Meaning:** Language that **guides or helps** the listener understand the message.

Accessibility and Limitations of Relevance Theory

This theory depends on **shared knowledge and context**. If people do not share the same background, misunderstanding can happen.

3.What is Implicature?

Implicature means understanding **more than the actual words** by using context or hints.

Conversational Implicature

It is an **implied meaning** that comes from the **conversation and context**.

Generalized Conversational Implicature

An implied meaning that is understood in **most situations**.

Example: *Some students passed.* → It usually means **not all students passed**.

Scalar Implicature

It happens when a speaker uses a **weaker word** instead of a stronger one.

Example: *She is rich.* → It may mean **she is not extremely rich**.

Particularized Conversational Implicature

This type depends on the **specific situation or context**.

Example: *It's late.* → It may mean **let's go home**.

Properties of Conversational Implicature

It **can be cancelled** without making the sentence wrong.

Example: *I don't like pizza, but I eat it sometimes.*

Conventional Implicature

This meaning comes from **specific words**, not from the context.

Example: *But* shows **contrast**.

Properties of Conventional Implicature

It **cannot be cancelled** because it is part of the word's meaning.

Strong Implicature

The implied meaning is **very clear and strong**.

Example: *John is coming soon.* → He will arrive **very soon**.

Weak Implicature

The implied meaning is **not very strong** and can have different meanings.

Example: *John is coming.* → He may come **soon or later**.

4. DEIXIS

What is Deixis?

Deixis means words whose meaning depends on the situation. These words can only be understood if we know **who is speaking, where they are, and when they are speaking**. Examples are **I, you, here, there, now, then**.

Spatial Deixis

Spatial deixis refers to **place or location**. It uses words like **here, there, above, below** to show where something is.

Person Deixis

Person deixis refers to **people in a conversation**. It includes words like **I, you, he, she, we, they**.

Social Deixis

Social deixis shows the **social relationship or status** between people. It includes titles such as **Mr., Mrs., Dr., Sir, Madam.**

Temporal Deixis

Temporal deixis refers to **time**. It uses words like **now, today, yesterday, tomorrow, then, soon.**

Discourse Deixis

Discourse deixis points to **a part of the conversation or text**. Words like **this, that, the following, the above** are used.

Deictic Reference

Deictic reference means that the meaning of words **depends on the context** of the conversation.

Deictic Center

The deictic center is the **main reference point** in communication. It is usually the **speaker, the current place, and the present time.**

Limits of Indexicality

Sometimes context is **not enough** to understand the meaning. If the situation is unclear, deictic words can also become confusing.

Raising Pragmatic Awareness

It means understanding **how context affects meaning** and learning to use deictic expressions correctly in communication.

5. PRESUPPOSITION AND ENTAILMENT IN PRAGMATICS

Presupposition

Presupposition is **background information** that the speaker assumes is already true before saying something.

Entailment

Entailment means **one statement logically leads to another statement.**

Types of Presupposition

There are different types of presupposition. One common type is **existence presupposition**, which assumes that a person or thing already exists.

Projection Problem

The projection problem is the difficulty of knowing **which presuppositions remain true** in different sentences.

Ordered Entailments

Ordered entailments happen when **one statement naturally implies another in order.**

Presupposition in the Real World

In daily life, people use **background knowledge and shared information** to understand each other easily.

6. SPEECH ACT THEORY

Speech Act Theory

Speech Act Theory explains that we use language **not only to say things but also to perform actions**, such as requesting, promising, apologizing, or thanking.

Austin's Speech Act Theory

John Austin said that **speaking is also doing an action**. For example, making a promise or giving an apology is an action.

Searle's Speech Act Theory

John Searle expanded Austin's ideas and divided speech acts into different types like **assertions, requests, questions, promises, and commands**.

Felicity Conditions

These are the **necessary conditions** that make a speech act successful. For example, a promise is only valid if the speaker really intends to keep it.

Direct Speech Acts

A direct speech act means **the speaker says exactly what he or she means**.

Example: *Give me the book.*

Indirect Speech Acts

An indirect speech act means **the speaker expresses the meaning politely or indirectly**.

Example: *Could you pass me the book?*

7. SPEECH ACTS AND SOCIETY

Social Dimensions

Speech acts change according to **social status, age, power, and relationship** between people.

Cultural Dimensions

Different cultures use speech acts **in different ways**, depending on their traditions and values.

Limitations of Speech Act Theory

Speech Act Theory cannot explain **every social and cultural situation**, so it has some limitations.

Macro-functions

Macro-functions are the **main purposes of communication**, such as giving information, making requests, asking questions, or giving instructions.

Exploring Speech Acts

It means studying **how people use language effectively** in different situations and cultures.

1. POLITENESS THEORY

What is Politeness Theory?

Politeness Theory explains **how people use language politely to show respect and avoid hurting others' feelings**.

Face Wants

Face means a person's **self-image or social respect**. Face wants are the desire to **keep a good image and avoid embarrassment**.

Negative Face

Negative face is the desire to **have freedom and not be disturbed or forced by others**.

Positive Face

Positive face is the desire to **be liked, respected, and appreciated by other people.**

Off Record

Off-record communication is **indirect.** The speaker gives a hint instead of saying something directly.

Example: *It's cold in here.* (Meaning: Please close the window.)

On Record

On-record communication is **direct and clear.**

Example: *Please close the window.*

Positive Politeness

Positive politeness uses **friendly and respectful language** to make others feel happy and valued.

Negative Politeness

Negative politeness uses **careful and polite language** to avoid putting pressure on someone.

Politeness Strategies

These are the methods people use to **show respect, be polite, and maintain good relationships** during communication.

2. Politeness and context

Form and Function

- **Form:** How something is said (formal or informal language).
- **Function:** Why something is said (request, compliment, apology, etc.).

Situational Context

Situational context means the **time, place, and situation** in which communication happens.

Social Context

Social context refers to the **relationship between the speakers**, such as friends, family, teachers, or strangers.

Cultural Context

Cultural context means the **customs, traditions, and values** that affect how people communicate.

Applying Politeness

Applying politeness means **using polite language according to the situation, culture, and relationship** to maintain respect and good communication.

3. CONVERSATIONAL ANALYSIS

What is Conversational Analysis?

Conversational Analysis is the **study of how people talk to each other**. It explains how conversations are organized, how people take turns, and how they respond.

Turn-Taking

Turn-taking means **speakers take turns while talking**. Normally, people speak one after another without interrupting.

Pauses, Overlaps, and Backchannels

- **Pauses:** Short moments of silence during a conversation.
- **Overlaps:** When **two people speak at the same time**.

- **Backchannels:** Small responses like "**uh-huh**," "**okay**," "**yes**" to show that we are listening.

Adjacency Pairs

Adjacency pairs are **two connected parts of a conversation**.

Examples:

- Question → Answer
- Greeting → Greeting
- Request → Response

Preference Structure

Preference structure means **some replies are more expected than others**. For example, agreement is usually preferred over disagreement.

Sequences

Sequences are the **order of conversation**. One part naturally leads to another, like greeting → small talk → goodbye.

4. CULTURE AND LANGUAGE LEARNING

Culture and Language Learning

Different cultures **use language in different ways**. Culture affects how people speak and understand each other.

Cross-cultural Pragmatics

It studies **how people from different cultures use language politely and effectively**.

Intercultural Pragmatics

It studies **communication between people from different cultures** and how they understand each other.

Inter-language Pragmatics

It studies **how second-language (L2) learners use language** in social situations.

Listener Behavior in CCP

It explains **how listeners understand and respond** to speakers according to culture and society.

5. COMPUTERS AND LINGUISTICS

Computers and Linguistics

It is the study of **how computers help in analyzing language**, grammar, and meaning.

Computers, Corpora, and Semantics

It uses **large collections of texts (corpora)** to study the meaning and use of words.

Computers and the Study of Translation

Computers help **translate one language into another** and make translation easier.

Computers and Pragmatics

Computers are used to study **how context changes the meaning** of language.

Computers, Speech Acts and Conversation

Technology helps study **speech acts and the structure of conversations**.

6. INFORMATION STRUCTURE AND PRAGMATICS

Introduction to Information Structure

Information structure means **organizing information clearly** so the listener can understand it easily.

Given and New Information

- **Given Information:** Information the listener **already knows**.
- **New Information:** Information the speaker **introduces for the first time**.

Topics and Contrast

- **Topic:** The **main subject** of the conversation.
- **Contrast:** Showing **differences** using words like **but, however**.

Definite and Referential Expressions

- **Definite Expressions:** Refer to a **specific known thing**. (Example: *the car*)
- **Referential Expressions:** Refer to something **without clearly identifying it**. (Example: *a car*)

Generic and Specific Expressions

- **Generic Expressions:** Talk about things **in general**. (Example: *Cats are friendly*.)
 - **Specific Expressions:** Talk about a **particular thing**. (Example: *My cat is friendly*.)
-

7. RESEARCH IN PRAGMATICS

Research in Pragmatics

It studies **how language is used in real-life communication.**

Nature of Pragmatic Investigation

It focuses on **how people use language in social situations,** including politeness and culture.

Collecting Data for Pragmatic Analysis

Researchers collect **real conversations and examples** to study language use.

Transcription of Conversation

It means **writing spoken conversations exactly as they are spoken.**

Investigable Topics

Research topics include **politeness, speech acts, deixis, implicature, and conversation.**

8. IMPORTANT TERMS IN PRAGMATICS

Ambiguity

A sentence has **more than one possible meaning.**

Disambiguation

It means **making the intended meaning clear.**

Vagueness

Language that is **not clear or not specific.**

Attributive Concept

Giving a **quality or characteristic** to something.

Example: *A tall man.*

Argumentation Theory

It studies **how people give reasons and arguments** in communication.

Code Model

Communication works by **encoding a message by the speaker and decoding it by the listener.**

Communicative Competence

The ability to **use language correctly and appropriately** in different situations.

Demonstrative

Words like **this, that, these, those** which point to something.

Ellipsis

Leaving out words because **their meaning is already understood.**

Folk Pragmatics

The everyday understanding of **how language is used** in society.

Formal Pragmatics

The study of language using **rules and logical methods.**

Experimental Pragmatics

It studies language by **doing experiments and research.**

Cognitive Pragmatics

It studies **how the brain understands language and meaning.**

Fragment

A group of words **that is not a complete sentence** but still gives meaning.

Metaphor

Comparing one thing with another.

Example: *Time is money.*

Synecdoche

Using a **part to represent the whole.**

Example: *All hands on deck.*

Hyperbole

An **exaggeration** used for emphasis.

Example: *I've told you a million times.*

Irony

Saying **the opposite of what you really mean.**

I-Principle and M-Principle

These principles explain **how information is organized** so listeners understand it correctly.

Q-Principle and R-Principle

These principles help make conversation **clear, relevant, and meaningful.**

Linguistic Under-determinacy Thesis

Language **does not always give complete meaning** without context.

Manifestness

How **clear and obvious** a message is.

Markedness

How **unusual or special** a word or expression is.

9. KEY THINKERS IN PRAGMATICS

John Langshaw Austin

He introduced **Speech Act Theory** and said that language is used to **perform actions** like promising and apologizing.

Noam Avram Chomsky

He is famous for his work on **syntax (sentence structure)** and language theory.

Herbert Paul Grice

He introduced **Implicature** and the **Cooperative Principle** in communication.

Stephen C. Levinson

He studied the **social and cultural use of language** in pragmatics.

John Rogers Searle

He expanded **Speech Act Theory** and explained different types of speech acts like **requests, promises, and commands**.

10. Interactional Construction of Identity

Interactional Construction of Identity

- It explains how our identity is shaped through language and communication.

Role of Sociocultural Factors in Identity

- Culture, society, social roles, and context affect how we see ourselves and how others see us.

Action Theory

- Our actions, especially the way we speak, help build and express our identity.

Studies of Identities

- It studies how people show and develop their identity through communication.

Occasioning Identity Work

- Some situations or conversations make people think about or change their identity.

Identity Work in an Educational Context

- Students and teachers build their identity through classroom language and interaction.

11. Language, Gender, and Power

Language, Gender, and Power

- It explains how language shows gender roles and power in society.

Enactment of Gender in Language Use

- People use language to express their gender identity.

Language and Gender: Western & Non-Western Perspectives

- Different cultures express gender differently through language.

Power: Language and Gender

- Language shows the power relationship between men and women.

Working of Language and Power: Political Discourse

- Politicians use language to influence and gain power.

Gender and Power Interactions

- Language shows how power works between different genders.

12. Classroom Pragmatic Development

Classroom Pragmatic Development

- It explains how learners develop language skills for real-life communication.

Why is Pragmatic Competence Important?

- It helps learners communicate politely and correctly in social situations.

Can Pragmatic Competence Be Taught?

- Yes. It can be taught through classroom activities and practice.

What Gets in the Way of Developing Pragmatic Competence?

- Lack of real-life practice and poor understanding of culture make learning difficult.

How to Improve Pragmatic Competence?

- Teachers should use role plays, real-life examples, and cultural activities.

Training Outside the Classroom

- Students can improve by watching movies, talking with people, and practicing in daily life.



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